iii) It is a metric system which means that multiples and submultiples can be expressed as powers of 10.



In SI, there are seven fundamental units as given in Table 1.2

Table 1.2 SI Base Quantities and Units

Base Quantity	SI Units		
	Unit	Symbol	Definition
Length	metre	m	One metre is the length of the path travelled by light in vacuum in 1/299,792,458 of a second (1983)
Mass	kilogram	kg	One kilogram is the mass of the prototype cylinder of platinum iridium alloy (whose height is equal to its diameter), preserved at the International Bureau of Weights and Measures at Serves, near Paris, France. (1901)
Time	second	s	One second is the duration of 9,192,631,770 periods of radiation corresponding to the transition between the two hyperfine levels of the ground state of Cesium-133 atom.(1967)
Electric current	ampere	A	One ampere is the constant current, which when maintained in each of the two straight parallel conductors of infinite length and negligible cross section, held one metre apart in vacuum shall produce a force per unit length of 2×10^{-7} N/m between them. (1948)
Temperature	kelvin	K	One kelvin is the fraction $\left(\frac{1}{273.16}\right)$ of the thermodynamic temperature of the triple point* of the water. (1967)
Amount of substance	mole	mol	One mole is the amount of substance which contains as many elementary entities as there are atoms in 0.012 kg of pure carbon-12. (1971)
Luminous intensity	candela	cd	One candela is the luminous intensity in a given direction, of a source that emits monochromatic radiation of frequency 5.4×10^{14} Hz and that has a radiant intensity of $\frac{1}{683}$ watt/steradian in that direction. (1979)

* Triple point of water is the temperature at which saturated vapour, pure water and melting ice are all in equilibrium. The triple point temperature of water is 273.16K

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